

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on experience in real estate disputes, case file management and client-facing legal work. Practical background preparing hearing bundles and court materials, maintaining electronic matter records, tracking deadlines across concurrent files and drafting correspondence at BCLP and Citizens Advice. Comfortable managing high document volumes, meeting hard deadlines and communicating clearly with clients on procedural matters. Looking to apply these skills in a conveyancing legal assistant role.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from client instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets firm deadlines across multiple concurrent files
- Interviews clients across housing, welfare, employment, debt and family matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex regulatory points
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials for property disputes
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records on iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Prepared client notes and cost comparisons

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions ahead of a significant submission deadline, ensuring on-time delivery
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external translations with a Romanian translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal requirements
- Reviewed data-processing and confidentiality provisions; researched UK and EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems; legal and commercial research; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, matter record maintenance, procedural histories, deadline tracking across concurrent files, high-volume document management, confidential file organisation